08-01 第2篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Day I Learned to Say "I Don't Know"

① For most of my first term in Grade 8, I was the quick-hand girl in English class. No matter what question Ms Lin asked, my arm shot up like a small rocket. I had an answer for everything — not always right, but always quick. My parents liked to tell their friends, "Yuan-Yuan is never afraid of questions." I believed this was something to be proud of. I did not know yet that "quick" and "right" are not the same word.

② The trouble began on a rainy Wednesday in November. We had a new English teacher for the week — Mrs Feng, who was covering for Ms Lin. She was small, grey-haired, and asked questions in an oddly calm voice. Halfway through the lesson, she wrote a sentence on the blackboard: *"She has been teaching at the school since 2015, hasn't she?"* She looked around the room. "Can anyone explain which tense this is, and why?"

③ My hand went up before I had even thought. Mrs Feng nodded at me. I started to speak — something about "present continuous", something about "because of 'since 2015'". Halfway through my answer, I realised I was wrong. But the sentence had already left my mouth. A small silence followed. Mrs Feng did not smile; she did not frown. "Thank you, Yuan-Yuan," she said. "Any other ideas?"

④ A quiet boy, Zhao, raised his hand slowly and gave the correct answer: present perfect continuous, used for an action that started in the past and is still going on. The class agreed. Mrs Feng wrote it clearly on the board. I felt my face grow hot. No one laughed at me, but inside I felt a strange, heavy feeling, as if I had dropped an important plate in front of everyone.

⑤ After class, while the other students ran out for the break, Mrs Feng called me to the front. I waited, my hands behind my back, ready for a gentle telling-off. Instead, she pulled out a chair, sat down, and looked at me kindly. "Yuan-Yuan," she said, "you are not in trouble. I want to teach you a small new word." She wrote three English letters on a piece of paper: "*I don't know.*"

⑥ "When a teacher asks a question," she said, "there are three good answers. One: the correct answer. Two: a careful idea, with the words 'I think' in front of it. Three: 'I don't know.' These three answers are all honest. The problem is not being wrong; the problem is pretending to be sure when we are not." She tapped her pen on the paper. "Quick is a gift. But honest is a bigger one."

⑦ I went home quiet that evening. I did not tell my parents. I opened my English book and looked at ten more grammar rules I had "guessed" during the term. Half of them

were not really in my head; I had only memorised a few words near them. I took a breath and made a deal with myself: for the next week, in every class, I would use Mrs Feng's three answers — never a fake-confident fourth one.

⑧ The first day was hard. In maths, the teacher asked about angles, and I opened my mouth to speak quickly; then I said, "I think... maybe... but I'm not sure." In history, I said out loud the words I had never said in class before: "I don't know." A few classmates looked at me, surprised. No one laughed. The history teacher smiled. "Good — now let's find out together," he said, and he spent five minutes explaining the point.

⑨ Slowly, something changed. I stopped being the "quick-hand girl" and became, I hope, a "clear-head girl". My hand still went up, but only after I had actually thought. The answers I gave were shorter but more often right. At the end of the term, my English grade rose by six marks, even though I spoke less in class. I understood then what Mrs Feng had meant on that rainy Wednesday: speed is nothing without honesty, and the three small words **"I don't know"** are not a sign of weakness. They are often the first door to really learning.

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. At the beginning of the story, what did the writer believe about herself?

A. She was the slowest student in the class.
B. She was "the quick-hand girl" and believed being quick to answer was something to be proud of.
C. She was afraid to speak English in class.
D. She hated every English lesson.

2. What happened after the writer gave a wrong answer to Mrs Feng's question?

A. The whole class laughed at her.
B. Mrs Feng calmly said "thank you" and asked if anyone else had ideas; a quiet boy then gave the correct answer.
C. Mrs Feng punished her by sending her outside.
D. Mrs Feng told her to leave the school.

3. What were the "three good answers" Mrs Feng taught the writer?

A. The correct answer; a careful idea with "I think" in front; and "I don't know".
B. Always shout "yes"; always shout "no"; and say nothing at all.
C. Only the correct answer; never anything else.
D. The longest answer; the shortest answer; and a very fast answer.

4. What happened when the writer first said "I don't know" in the history class?

A. The teacher got angry and sent her home.
B. The teacher smiled and said "Now let's find out together", and spent five minutes explaining the point.
C. The other students made fun of her for days.
D. The teacher gave her a low mark on the spot.

5. What does the writer mainly want to tell us?

A. Quick students are always the best students.
B. Saying "I don't know" is a sign of weakness and should be avoided.
C. Speed without honesty is shallow; admitting "I don't know" is not weak but is often the first door to real learning.
D. English grammar is too hard to learn.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段
【解析】她是"举手最快的女生"，并为此自豪。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③—④段
【解析】老师平静致谢，另一位同学给出正确答案。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段
【解析】三种诚实回答：对、我想…、我不知道。B/C/D 均错。故选 A。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑧段末句
【解析】历史老师肯定并当场讲解。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题

【定位】第⑨段末句
【解析】承认不知是真学习的起点。A/B/D 均偏。故选 C。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **cover** [v.] 代课
- **tense** [n.] 时态
- **memorise** [v.] 记住
- **fake** [adj.] 假的
- **honesty** [n.] 诚实